

HEADLINE JUDGMENT

Note: 24 Jul figures are intraday prints; 23 Jul is now a final close (\$94.26 Brent). Restated continuation series (front-month CO2/CL2) in force. Score HOLDS at 25/30 — all six channels unchanged, an eighth session at 25 — but the 23 Jul session was the war's most violent single-day repricing in seven weeks. Brent closed \$94.26, the first \$94-handle close since 4 Jun (+\$4.08 d/d, the largest daily close-to-close gain since early June), after the intraday high \$95.30 PIERCED the \$95 oil→3 trigger level — on the close-basis rule no trigger fired, and the gap to the trigger is now 74 cents; the ACTIVE contract (COA) closed \$100.69, the first triple-digit close on the unscored board since 22 May. The driver was kinetic: the Houthi embargo turned from declaration to attack — missiles and drones hit the Saudi tanker Encelia and targeted the Layla in the Red Sea, five Saudi tankers reversed course, and the IRGC says a tanker caught fire in a mined route south of Hormuz. The rates complex followed: the 10Y closed 4.6932% — its highest close of the war and a SECOND consecutive close above the 4.65% Stage-4 leg — and the 30Y closed 5.1595%, leaving 4.1 bp to its 5.20% leg (intraday 5.1732%, 2.7 bp). MOVE closed 80.08, the first 80-handle since 20 May on a fifth consecutive rise, and VIX snapped back to 18.70 — equities are joining. AAA gasoline printed \$4.72 (22 Jul) — a seventh consecutive rise, 3 cents from the political→5 trigger. The lone easing gauge: 5Y5Y closed 2.1995%, back below the 2.20% line after three closes above. Asia LNG printed FRESH at ¥3,601, a new war-era record (+115.8%). A twelfth consecutive night of strikes; Rubio says Iran is 'paying the price'; Trump warns of a 'massive attack' if Iran fails to negotiate; the 10-day framework remains tabled, unaccepted. No trigger fired on a confirmed close, so no channel moved — but oil→3 (74c), political→5 (3c) and Stage-4 Threshold B (4.1 bp) all now sit inside ONE normal session's move. Both event channels remain maxed — the hold is an artifact of the scale. Sequencing 25 → 25 → 25.

1 · Live tape

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

24 Jul 2026 readings are intraday prints; 23 Jul and earlier are final closes (restated continuation series; front-month CO2/CL2). d/d deltas are 24 Jul intraday vs 23 Jul close; w/w deltas are vs 17 Jul close.

Benchmark	Intraday 24 Jul	Δ d/d	Δ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent front-month	\$93.49 /bbl (H 94.49 / L 93.41)	−\$0.77 (+\$7.17 w/w)	from \$72.48 (+29.0%) — ~\$21.0/bbl premium; easing off a 23 Jul high of \$95.30 that pierced the \$95 oil→3 trigger level; active COA prints \$100.00	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent · 23 Jul close (final)	\$94.26 /bbl (+\$3.10 vs my 23 Jul intraday \$91.16)	+\$4.08 d/d — largest daily gain since early June; first \$94-handle close since 4 Jun	74 cents below the \$95 trigger on a close basis; the intraday high \$95.30 was through the level but the close was not	CO2 Comdty
WTI front-month	\$86.25 /bbl	−\$0.76 (+\$4.47 w/w)	from \$67.02 (+28.7%) — the CL2 artifact narrowed: the 23 Jul CL2 close \$87.01 vs active CLA \$92.19; CLA prints \$91.49 intraday	CL2 Comdty
Brent–WTI spread	\$7.24 /bbl	widened	~\$8.5 on the active contracts	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	\$2.907 /MMBtu	−\$0.009 (−\$0.00 w/w)	from \$3.06 (−5.1%) — US gas BELOW pre-war; not Hormuz-exposed	NGA Comdty
TTF Dutch gas (active)	€61.96 /MWh	+€0.06 (+€4.57 w/w)	from €31.23 (+98.4%) — eased off the record €62.54 close; the 23 Jul close €61.90 sits just under the doubling line	TZTA Comdty
Japan/Asia LNG (23 Jul close — FRESH print)	¥3,601	+¥102 vs 22 Jul	from ¥1,669 (+115.8%) — a NEW war-era record, the second in two sessions; no 24 Jul print (flagged, not carried)	JGLA Comdty

	Current reading	Source
Strait · twelfth night of strikes · embargo turns kinetic	US bombing entered a twelfth consecutive night (23 Jul), hitting maritime, missile/drone and air-defence assets including near Bushehr; the Houthis hit the Saudi tanker Encelia and targeted the Layla in the Red Sea; the IRGC says a tanker caught fire in a mined route south of Hormuz (Tier 3); the 10-day ceasefire remains tabled and unaccepted.	CENTCOM / CNN / The National / WaPo / Irish Times
Insurance & traffic	Transits ~17% of typical (15 vs 88/day, 19 Jul count); 425 anchored (basis revised from 443–444); 74 tankers AIS-dark in 24h vs a 53.2 7-day average; war-risk ~8×, VLCC ~\$2.5m; six P&I; clubs withdrawn; all 9 major carriers suspended, limited or rerouting via the Cape.	straits.live / Windward

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

24 Jul 2026 yields are intraday. d/d deltas are vs the 23 Jul close; w/w vs 17 Jul. The 10Y Stage-4 leg has now held above its line for TWO consecutive closes (4.6545%, 4.6932%); the 30Y leg is 4.1 bp away on a close basis and is the sole binding constraint.

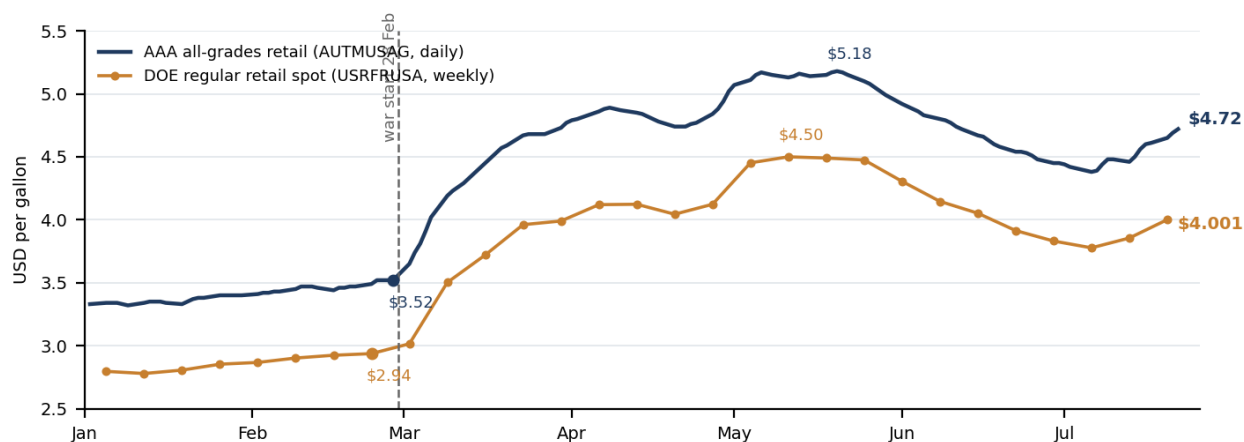
Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 24 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
2-year UST	4.35	+0.5	+17.5	+98 (from 3.37%)	USGG2YR Index
5-year UST	4.46	+0.4	+17.8	+95 (from 3.50%)	USGG5YR Index
10-year UST	4.70	+0.8	+15.4	+76 (from 3.94%) — 23 Jul close 4.6932%, the HIGHEST close of the war; a second consecutive close above the 4.65% Stage-4 leg — now sustained	USGG10YR Index

Tenor	Yield (%) — intraday 24 Jul	Δ d/d (bp)	Δ w/w (bp)	Δ vs pre-war (bp)	BBG ticker
30-year UST	5.17	+1.4	+10.4	+56 (from 4.61%) — 23 Jul close 5.1595%, highest since 19 May; 4.1 bp below the 5.20% Stage-4 leg (2.7 bp intraday) — the binding constraint	USGG30YR Index
2s10s spread	+35 bp	+0.3	−1.7	−21 (flatter)	USYC2Y10 Index
10Y breakeven inflation	2.264 (lagged; 23 Jul close)	−1.8 (at close)	—	+0.7 (from 2.257%) — a third close above the pre-war anchor, but easing	USGGBE10 Index
5Y5Y forward inflation	2.20	+0.4	+0.8	+6.2 (from 2.14%) — the 23 Jul close 2.1995% fell BACK BELOW the 2.20% line after three closes above; 10.0 bp below the →5 trigger; the lone easing gauge	USGG5Y5Y Index
SOFR (lagged print, 22 Jul)	3.62	—	—	series lags	SOFRRATE Index

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg

Gauge	Latest	As of	Δ vs pre-war	Interpretation
DXY	101.38	24 Jul intraday	+3.77 (from 97.61)	Rangebound ~101 — marginally softer d/d; still no haven bid; the dollar is not the stress valve.
MOVE	80.08	23 Jul close (24 Jul lagged)	+6.70 (from 73.38)	First 80-handle since 20 May, on a FIFTH consecutive rise (70.88 → 80.08) — the fastest ascent since April. Both Treasury-downgrade legs now fail at the widest margin of the war.
VIX	18.70	23 Jul close (24 Jul lagged)	−1.16 (from 19.86)	SNAPPED BACK +2.06 (16.64 → 18.70) on the tanker attacks — the first sign that equities are joining; the rates/equity divergence narrowed.
AAA gasoline	\$4.72 /gal	22 Jul print (latest; 23–24 Jul pending)	+\$1.20 (from \$3.52, +34%)	The political-stress reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18). Seventh consecutive rise; 3 cents below the \$4.75 threshold — the next confirmed print lands at or through it at the recent 3–5c pace.
DOE gasoline	\$4.001 /gal	20 Jul weekly print	~+\$1.06 (from ~\$2.94, +36%)	First \$4-handle since 15 Jun; next weekly print lands Monday 27 Jul.

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest \$4.72 on 22 Jul); USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is the complementary gauge (pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.001 on 20 Jul). The AAA series has risen in seven consecutive prints and sits 3 cents from the \$4.75 political→5 threshold; the 23–24 Jul prints are pending and the next lands at or through the trigger at the recent pace — the channel is evaluated on confirmed prints only, so the score holds until the data lands.

Strait operational state

Indicator	Current reading	Source
Strait closed · day ~146	Closed to commercial traffic (blockade regime since 28 Feb war start); US naval blockade plus escort operation (~900 escorted transits, ~450m bbl since early May, per CENTCOM); Iran conditions transit on its own coordination and fees.	CENTCOM / maritime trackers
Twelfth consecutive night of US strikes + mined-route incident	CENTCOM strikes on 23 Jul hit maritime capabilities, missile and drone storage, coastal surveillance and air-defence assets across western and central Iran, including near Bushehr. Rubio: Iran is 'paying the price'; Trump warns of a 'massive attack' if Iran fails to negotiate. The IRGC says a tanker caught fire in a 'mined route' south of the Strait (Tier 3, partially corroborated); the UK withdrew embassy staff.	CENTCOM / CNN / Irish Times / UK FCDO
Houthi embargo TURNS KINETIC — first hits on Saudi tankers	Missiles and drones hit the Saudi tanker Encelia (bow fire; crew safe) and targeted the Layla in the Red Sea on 23 Jul — the first attacks executed under the embargo of Saudi ports. Five Saudi tankers reversed course 21 Jul, four toward Suez; Kpler had put ~75% of Saudi crude exports through Yanbu. ANZ: 'a serious escalation'; Goldman sees \$120+ Brent by Q4 if disruptions persist.	The National / WaPo / Bloomberg / NBC
Mediation — ceasefire still tabled, unaccepted	The Qatar/Egypt/Pakistan/Oman 10-day framework remains received and unaccepted; rhetoric hardened this session; no venue or date named — the decision window is still described as days.	Axios / CNBC / Irish Times

2 · US economic shock — analysis with bond yields

The US economic shock holds at 25/30, but the 23 Jul session compressed every remaining distance at once: Brent's intraday high pierced the \$95 trigger level before a \$94.26 close (74 cents short), the 10Y put in the highest close of the war and its second consecutive close above the 4.65% Stage-4 leg, the 30Y closed 4.1 bp from the last Stage-4 leg, MOVE printed its first 80-handle since 20 May, and the AAA gasoline print landed 3 cents from the political→5 trigger. Nothing crossed a scoring trigger on a confirmed close, so no channel moved — but three separate triggers (oil, political, Stage-4 B) now sit inside one normal session's move, and the catalyst that produced the session — the Houthi embargo turning kinetic against Saudi tankers — is aimed directly at the bypass architecture that has kept oil at 2/5. The lone easing gauge was 5Y5Y, which slipped back below the 2.20% line.

2.1 · Bond-yield transmission

24 Jul yields are intraday; d/d vs 23 Jul close, w/w vs 17 Jul. No channel moved; score held at 25.

(i) Treasury — held at 5; the downgrade condition fails at the widest margin of the war. The 30Y closed 23 Jul at 5.1595% — highest since 19 May — with the cushion above the 5.00% downgrade leg widening 14.5 → 16 bp; and MOVE closed 80.08, a fifth consecutive rise and the first 80-handle since 20 May. The hold is fully fundamentals-based: term premium, supply concession into next week's FOMC (28–29 Jul), and a war-risk premium re-building on the Red Sea escalation. The intraday 30Y prints 5.1732% — 2.7 bp below the Stage-4 leg.

(ii) Inflation anchor — held at 4; the advance reversed at the line. 5Y5Y closed 2.1995% — back below the 2.20% line after three consecutive closes above it — and prints 2.2035% intraday. The 10Y breakeven closed 2.2637%, a third consecutive close above the pre-war anchor but easing (–1.8 bp). The 2.30% →5 trigger is 10.0 bp away on a close basis — the distance WIDENED this session, the only one on the board that did. Whether this is consolidation or a top is the week's inflation question; the downgrade (a sustained move to the 2.142% anchor) remains far.

(iii) Oil — held at 2 by 74 cents. The 23 Jul close \$94.26 is the first \$94-handle close since 4 Jun and the largest daily gain since early June (+\$4.08); the intraday high \$95.30 was THROUGH the \$95 trigger level, but the close was not, and the channel moves on confirmed closes only — one close above \$95 would still need a second to satisfy 'sustained'. The ACTIVE contract closed \$100.69, the first triple-digit close on the unscored board since 22 May, and prints \$100.00 this morning. The cause is structural, not headline froth: the Houthi embargo is now shooting at the tankers that carry the Saudi bypass volumes — the Encelia hit and the five course reversals put the ~75%-via-Yanbu flow directly at risk — while the IRGC's mined-route claim (Tier 3) pressures the Hormuz escort lane itself. Today's intraday tape has eased to \$93.49; a settle near here keeps the trigger un-fired into Monday. (The CL2 WTI artifact narrowed: CL2 closed \$87.01 vs the active CLA \$92.19; WTI levels are still read off the active board.)

2.2 · What would push the shock to Stage 4

Stage 4 is a credit/auction event. The 10Y leg of Threshold B is now sustained; the 30Y leg is the last one standing, 4.1 bp away.

Threshold A · 13 May 30Y auction. Historical. Cleared at 5.050%; the 9 Jul re-opening cleared 5.06% with a 0.3 bp stop-through. With the 30Y closing 5.1595% and rising, any long-duration supply now prices well above both — and next week's FOMC (28–29 Jul; markets price ~80% no-change) is the macro overlay.

Threshold B · 30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65%. The 10Y leg is SUSTAINED — two consecutive closes above the line (4.6545%, 4.6932%, the latter the war's highest), with the intraday at 4.7015%. The 30Y closed 5.1595%, 4.1 bp below its leg (23 Jul: 5.5 bp; now 4.1), and prints 5.1732% intraday — 2.7 bp below. At the past week's ~1–2 bp/session long-end drift the gap is a matter of sessions, and the catalysts are stacked: FOMC Tuesday–Wednesday, any long-duration supply, or one more risk-off session like 23 Jul. B tripping is the score's bridge toward the systemic scenarios.

Threshold C · MOVE above 130. Still far — but closing fastest. MOVE 80.08 is a fifth consecutive rise and the highest print since 20 May; the +3.77 jump on 23 Jul was the largest of the sequence. VIX joined at 18.70 (+2.06) — the vol repricing is no longer rates-only.

2.3 · Cross-asset

The repricing broadened this session — levels first, rates vol second, and now the first equity-vol response: VIX snapped back to 18.70 on the tanker attacks while MOVE printed an 80-handle. The dollar stayed flat at ~101 — still no haven bid, which keeps the stress reading in rates and energy rather than in a flight-to-quality. The gas complex stayed at records: Asia LNG's fresh ¥3,601 print is a new war-era high (+115.8%), TTF eased to €61.90 just under its doubling line, and US Henry Hub sits 5.1% BELOW pre-war — the signature of a Hormuz/LNG-routing shock, not a global-energy shock, fully intact. The cross-asset risk is no longer hypothetical geography: the embargoed Yanbu outlet that carried ~75% of Saudi exports is now under fire, and a hit on a laden VLCC or on terminal infrastructure would move crude, breakevens and bond vol together, at full amplitude.

3 · Shock score

Total: **25/30 — CRISIS band.** Band thresholds: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis.

Channel	Score	Rationale	Triggers
Maritime denial	5/5	Held at 5 (max). Strait closed to commercial traffic; transits ~17% of typical; 425 ships anchored; 74 tankers AIS-dark in 24h vs a 53.2 average; six P&I; clubs withdrawn; all 9 major carriers suspended or rerouting; the embargo now extends the denial regime to Saudi Red Sea ports by force. No verified reopening.	↑ at max. ↓ verified reopening (escorted convoys) with traffic above 25% of normal for 10 sessions → to 3–4.
Oil price shock	2/5	Held at 2 — by 74 cents. The 23 Jul close \$94.26 (+\$4.08, largest daily gain since early June; first \$94-handle since 4 Jun); the intraday high \$95.30 pierced the trigger level but the close did not; the ACTIVE contract closed \$100.69. Confirmed closes only, and 'sustained' needs a second close.	↑ Brent above \$95 sustained → to 3. ↓ mediated pause + close back at/below the \$72.48 anchor → to 1.
US inflation impulse	4/5	Held at 4. 5Y5Y closed 2.1995% — back below the 2.20% line after three closes above; intraday 2.2035%. 10Y BE closed above its pre-war anchor a third time but eased (2.264%). 10.0 bp below the →5 trigger — the only distance on the board that widened this session.	↑ 5Y5Y sustained above 2.30% → to 5. ↓ 5Y5Y sustained at/below the 2.142% pre-war anchor → to 3.
Treasury stress	5/5	Held at 5 — fundamentals-held at the widest margin of the war. 30Y closed 5.1595% (highest since 19 May), 16 bp above the 5.00% leg; MOVE 80.08, first 80-handle since 20 May on a fifth straight rise. Both downgrade legs fail simultaneously and the failure is deepening.	↑ at max. ↓ 30Y close under 5.00% with MOVE under 75 sustained → to 4.
Political stress	4/5	Held at 4 — one print from the trigger. AAA \$4.72 (22 Jul print, latest confirmed) — seventh consecutive rise, 3c below \$4.75; DOE weekly \$4.001. The 23–24 Jul prints are pending; at the recent 3–5c pace the next print lands at or through the threshold. Evaluated on confirmed prints only.	↑ gasoline above \$4.75 sustained → to 5. ↓ toward the \$3.52 pre-war level → to 3.
Escalation risk	5/5	Held at 5 (max). Twelfth consecutive night of US strikes; the Houthi embargo turned kinetic against Saudi tankers; a mined-route tanker fire south of Hormuz; Rubio's 'paying the price' and Trump's 'massive attack' warning; the ceasefire framework remains unaccepted with no venue or date named.	↑ at max. ↓ mediated stand-down + talks resume → to 4–3.
TOTAL	25/30	CRISIS band — eighth session at 25, with three triggers inside one session's move: political →5 is 3c away on a pending print, oil →3 is 74c on a close basis (intraday already pierced; active board through \$100), Stage-4 B is 4.1 bp on its last leg. US-inflation →5 widened to 10.0 bp. With both event channels maxed, only market channels can move the score.	

4 · What's changed since the last edition (23 Jul → 24 Jul AM)

Score holds at 25/30 for an eighth session — through the war's most violent repricing day in seven weeks. No channel moved; three triggers now sit inside one session's move. Source: Bloomberg.

The Houthi embargo turned kinetic. Missiles and drones hit the Saudi tanker Encelia (bow fire; crew safe) and targeted the Layla in the Red Sea on 23 Jul — the first executed attacks under the embargo of Saudi ports; five Saudi tankers had already reversed course. The route that carried ~75% of Saudi crude exports in early July is now under fire. Source: The National / Washington Post / Bloomberg.

Brent pierced \$95 intraday and closed \$94.26 — 74 cents from the trigger. The +\$4.08 close-to-close gain was the largest since early June; the active COA closed \$100.69, the first triple-digit close on the unscored board since 22 May, and Goldman now sees \$120+ by Q4 if disruptions persist. Source: Bloomberg / The National.

The 10Y put in the highest close of the war; the 30Y is 4.1 bp from completing Threshold B. 10Y 4.6932% — a second consecutive close above the 4.65% leg, making it sustained; 30Y 5.1595% (intraday 5.1732%, 2.7 bp below the 5.20% leg). Source: Bloomberg.

The vol complex broadened: MOVE 80.08, VIX snapped +2.06 to 18.70. First MOVE 80-handle since 20 May, fifth straight rise; the first meaningful equity-vol response of the month. Source: Bloomberg.

5Y5Y slipped back below 2.20% — the lone easing gauge. Closed 2.1995% after three closes above the line; the →5 distance widened to 10.0 bp. Source: Bloomberg.

Asia LNG set a second consecutive war-era record. Fresh 23 Jul print ¥3,601 (+115.8% vs pre-war); TTF eased to €61.90, just under its doubling line. Source: Bloomberg.

Gasoline: a seventh consecutive rise, 3 cents from the trigger. The 22 Jul AAA print landed at \$4.72; the 23–24 Jul prints are pending. Source: AAA / Bloomberg.

5 · Scenario map · next 7 to 30 days

Scenario	P	Description	Market path
Return to full war	38%	The modal path: a twelfth night of strikes, hardened rhetoric on both sides ('paying the price'; the massive-attack warning), the ceasefire unaccepted with no venue or date, and the Houthis now executing attacks rather than declaring them.	Brent \$105–140; MOVE above 90; oil to 3–4, political to 5, US-inflation to 5; score 28–30.
Contained but violent — blockaded stalemate	21%	Strikes continue but stay off major energy infrastructure; escort-only transits; the bypass pipelines keep capping crude. Eroding fastest: the embargo is now shooting at the bypass tankers, the front-month closed \$94.26 and the active board is through \$100.	Brent \$88–96; MOVE 76–86; risk premium \$18–26/bbl; score 25–26 as political→5 lands.
Deal collapse — MoU formally lapses	20%	The ceasefire proposal is rejected or expires; sanctions harden; the strait stays shut; fighting persists at high intensity without full-war targeting.	Brent \$92–108; oil to 3; 30Y above 5.20% with the 10Y leg already sustained (Stage-4 B trips); score 26–27.
Regional relapse — Gulf energy infrastructure hit	12%	Iran or the Houthis escalate from tankers to terminals: Yanbu, the East–West pipeline, Abqaiq/Ras Tanura or Fujairah. The first tanker hits under the embargo make this the best-armed tail in the map — the remaining step is from ship to shore.	Brent \$150+; emergency policy; HY spreads above 500 bp; score 29–30.
Mediated pause — the 10-day ceasefire sticks	9%	Washington and Tehran accept the Qatar/Egypt/Pakistan/Oman framework; strikes halt, both lanes reopen under the fee regime. Still formally live, but this session's rhetoric and the Red Sea escalation both cut against near-term acceptance.	Brent \$74–86; MOVE under 70; Treasury→4, US-inflation→3, escalation→4; score falls toward 20–22.

Probability shifts from the 23 Jul edition: regional relapse +2 (10→12) — the embargo moved from declaration to execution with the Encelia hit, and only the ship-to-shore step remains; contained-but-violent –2 (23→21) — the containment equilibrium now takes direct fire on its bypass leg; return to full war holds at 38 — rhetoric hardened but no strategic-target crossing yet; deal collapse holds at 20; mediated pause holds at 9 — the framework survives, unaccepted. Driver: the same 24 hours produced the war's largest oil repricing in seven weeks and its first executed attacks on Saudi shipping.

6 · Watchlist · next 24–72 hours

Political →5 (\$4.75) — one print away. AAA confirmed at \$4.72 (22 Jul), rising for seven straight prints; the 23–24 Jul prints are pending. A confirmed print at/above \$4.75 takes the score to 26 — the first move off 25 in eight sessions. The DOE weekly lands Monday 27 Jul.

Oil →3 (\$95) — 74 cents on a close basis, already pierced intraday. Today's tape has eased to \$93.49; a weekend of Red Sea headlines lands on Monday's open. One close above \$95 starts the clock; a second confirms. The active board is already through \$100 — the continuation series rolls toward it.

Stage-4 Threshold B — the 30Y is the last leg, 4.1 bp (2.7 intraday). The 10Y leg is sustained. The FOMC meets Tuesday–Wednesday (28–29 Jul, ~80% priced for no change): a hawkish read, any long-duration supply, or one more 23 Jul-sized session trips it. B is the bridge from 25–26 toward the systemic scenarios.

Ship-to-shore escalation in the Red Sea. The Encelia and Layla attacks put the embargo in execution; the tell to watch is a strike on a laden VLCC out of Yanbu or on terminal infrastructure — that is the regional-relapse trigger and it re-prices crude, breakevens and bond vol together.

The ceasefire decision window — rhetoric moved against it. Rubio's 'paying the price' and the massive-attack warning cut against acceptance; the framework remains tabled with no venue or date. Acceptance is still the first downgrade path in weeks (escalation 5→4).

US-inflation →5 (5Y5Y above 2.30% sustained) — 10.0 bp, and now the swing gauge. The pullback below 2.20% is the board's only easing signal; whether it is a top or a pause decides if the score's ceiling this fortnight is 26 or 28.

Gas complex — second consecutive Asia LNG record. ¥3,601 on the fresh 23 Jul print; no 24 Jul print yet — verify, never carry. Watch Asian demand-rationing headlines into the weekend.

7 · Source log · this edition

Tier 1 — primary market data. Bloomberg Terminal extract (US Iran BBG Data.xlsx, restated front-month continuation series). Tickers: CO2/CL2 Comdty (Brent/WTI front-month; the CL2 artifact narrowed this session — CL2 closed \$87.01 vs active CLA \$92.19; WTI is still read off the active board); COA/CLA Comdty (active, unscored, quoted for corroboration — COA closed \$100.69, prints \$100.00); NGA/TZTA/JGLA Comdty (JGLA printed FRESH 23 Jul at ¥3,601 — a new war-era record; no 24 Jul print); USGG2YR/5YR/10YR/20YR/30YR Index; USYC2Y10; USGGBE10 (23 Jul close 2.2637; 24 Jul lagged); USGG5Y5Y; SOFRRATE (lagged, 22 Jul); MOVE and VIX (23 Jul closes 80.08 / 18.70; 24 Jul lagged); DXY; AUTMUSAG (AAA pump — score reference; latest print 22 Jul \$4.72; 23–24 Jul pending) and USRFRUSA (DOE regular spot, weekly — corroboration; 20 Jul print \$4.001).

Tier 1 — news and institutional. CENTCOM via CNN / Irish Times (twelfth consecutive night of strikes; targets — maritime capabilities, missile and drone storage, coastal surveillance, air defences; Rubio remarks; the massive-attack warning), The National / Washington Post / Bloomberg / NBC (Houthi attacks on the Encelia and Layla; five Saudi tankers reversing course; ANZ and Goldman commentary — \$120+ Q4 Brent if disruptions persist), Axios / CNBC (10-day ceasefire framework — received, unaccepted; mediator push), straits.live / Windward (day count, transits ~17% of typical on the 19 Jul count, 425 anchored on the revised basis, 74 AIS-dark in 24h vs 53.2 avg, 8× war-risk cover, six P&I; withdrawals, all-9-carrier disruption), Federal Reserve calendar (FOMC 28–29 Jul), UK FCDO (embassy staff withdrawal).

Tier 3 — state media (labelled). The IRGC claim that a tanker caught fire in a 'mined route' south of Hormuz is labelled Tier 3; it is partially corroborated by traffic-diversion data but no independent confirmation of mining is available, and it is not used for any scoring decision. IRNA, Mehr, Press TV used only with explicit role labels.

8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh the Bloomberg extract	Parse the latest dated row (24 Jul) as intraday; reclassify 23 Jul as a final close; re-map columns via the robust scan (front-month CO2/CL2; both gasoline series; JGLA checked fresh — printed 23 Jul ¥3,601, flagged rather than carried for 24 Jul; MOVE/VIX/BE10 24 Jul lagged, 23 Jul closes carried and labelled; SOFR lagged 22 Jul).
2	Recompute deltas	d/d vs the 23 Jul close; w/w vs the close five trading sessions back (17 Jul this edition); vs-pre-war vs the 27 Feb 2026 anchor (re-verified, unchanged).
3	Re-evaluate the six channels	Market channels move on confirmed closes only — all held: oil 2 (close \$94.26, under \$95 despite the \$95.30 intraday high); Treasury 5 (30Y 5.1595% above 5.00%; MOVE 80.08 above 75); US-inflation 4 (5Y5Y 2.1995%, under 2.30%); political 4 (AAA \$4.72 confirmed, under \$4.75). Maritime/escalation event-based, both maxed.
4	Reconcile against the prior edition	The US session marked up violently through the Asia snapshot: Brent 23 Jul intraday \$91.16 → close \$94.26 (+\$3.10, the second-largest gap of the war); 10Y 4.6505% → 4.6932% (+4.3 bp); 30Y 5.1396% → 5.1595% (+2.0 bp); TTF €62.90 → €61.90 close (–€1.00); 5Y5Y 2.2177% → 2.1995% (–1.8 bp); MOVE 76.31 (carried) → 80.08 close.
5	Update scenarios and watchlist	Re-rank catalysts: political→5 (one pending print, 3c), oil→3 (74c on a close basis; pierced intraday; active board through \$100), Stage-4 B (30Y last leg, 4.1 bp; FOMC 28–29 Jul), US-inflation→5 (10.0 bp, widened); regional relapse 10→12 on the executed tanker attacks; full war holds 38% modal.

9 • Methodology

Shock-score scale. Six transmission channels (maritime denial, oil price shock, US inflation impulse, Treasury stress, political stress, escalation risk), each 0–5, summed to 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · 22–30 crisis. Market/economic channels move only on a confirmed close through a trigger; escalation-risk is event-based. **Hysteresis note:** upgrades fire on a sustained break; downgrades only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold — deliberately, to avoid whipsawing. Treasury (5) was held through 15–17 Jul on hysteresis when MOVE fell below 75; as of the 23 Jul close both downgrade legs fail at the widest margin of the war (30Y 5.1595% vs the 5.00% leg; MOVE 80.08 vs the 75 leg) — the hold is fully fundamentals-based. The same discipline held oil at 2 this session: the intraday high pierced \$95 but the close did not, and a first close above \$95 would still need a second to satisfy 'sustained'. **Scale cap:** maritime and escalation are both at 5/5, so further geopolitical deterioration — including the executed tanker attacks and the mined-route incident — cannot raise the score; only the four market channels can. A flat 25 must not be read as stability.

Gasoline series. Political-stress is scored on AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump; pre-war \$3.52, peak \$5.18, latest confirmed print \$4.72 on 22 Jul — a seventh consecutive rise) for continuity; the 23–24 Jul prints are pending in the extract and the channel holds until they are confirmed. USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot; pre-war ~\$2.94, peak \$4.50, latest \$4.001 on 20 Jul; next print Monday 27 Jul) is tracked alongside. See the chart in section 1.

Pre-war anchor (27 Feb 2026 close). Brent \$72.48; WTI \$67.02; 2Y 3.375%; 5Y 3.502%; 10Y 3.938%; 30Y 4.611%; 2s10s +55.64 bp; 5Y5Y 2.142%; 10Y BE 2.257%; MOVE 73.38; VIX 19.86; DXY 97.608; gasoline (AAA) \$3.52; Henry Hub \$3.06; TTF €31.23; Asia LNG ¥1,669. (Re-verified — unchanged.) Brent +29.0%, WTI +28.7%, TTF +98.4%, Asia LNG +115.8%; the 30Y (+56 bp), 10Y (+76 bp), 5Y5Y (+6.2 bp), 10Y BE (+0.7 bp), MOVE (+6.70) and DXY (+3.77) all sit above their anchors; VIX and US Henry Hub remain below pre-war — though VIX's +2.06 snap on the tanker attacks is the first sign of the equity complex joining.

Intraday caveat. The latest dated row is a Singapore-AM intraday snapshot; US-hours trading and headlines set the close (recent reconciliation gaps on Brent: +\$4.01, +\$2.46, –\$0.90, +\$1.91, +\$0.60, +\$3.10 — the 23 Jul gap was the second-largest of the war). The CL2 WTI series remains flagged as a data artifact against the active CLA contract, though the gap narrowed this session; WTI levels are read off the active board pending resolution. Market-channel triggers are evaluated on confirmed closes; escalation-risk is event-based. Absolute levels use the restated continuation series and are not directly comparable with pre-restatement editions, though the directional analysis is continuous.